NCCP 00805 · VERSION 2

Your treatment, explained

NCCP 00805: recurrent malignant glioma. · NCCP 00805 v2 · Document revised 5 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Lomustine for recurrent malignant glioma

42-day cycle | Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

ACT ON SYMPTOMS, NOT THE CALENDAR

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Use your oncology unit's written emergency plan. Fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell needs urgent advice even on days without chemotherapy. Call 112 or 999 for a new seizure, sudden weakness or speech difficulty, loss of consciousness, severe breathing difficulty or uncontrolled bleeding. If you have an established seizure rescue plan, follow it and its emergency instructions. Call promptly for fever, bleeding, new cough or breathlessness, persistent vomiting or reduced urine. Do not take another lomustine dose without a new instruction.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

Your treatment and urgent-contact card is supplied separately and in the wallet-card section of the complete handbook.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc · nci-cns

Reference contents

YOUR COMPLETE REFERENCE

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UNDERSTAND YOUR TREATMENT

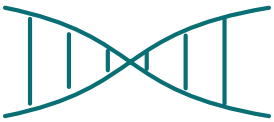
How your medicines work

Lomustine is an oral chemotherapy used to help control recurrent malignant glioma. The team considers your exact diagnosis, earlier treatments, function and priorities when deciding whether to continue.

ORAL CHEMOTHERAPY CAPSULE

Lomustine

CCNU



Damages DNA

Lomustine is an oral nitrosourea chemotherapy that can reach the brain. It damages DNA and interferes with cell division. Its effects on healthy blood-forming cells can appear several weeks after the dose and can build up over successive cycles. This explains the long gap between doses and the need for continuing blood tests.

One scheduled dose → DNA damaged → Delayed blood-count effects possible

What to watch for

This is one dose on Day 1, not a daily medicine. If an extra dose is taken, get urgent advice even if you feel well. Keep blood tests after the dose and report fever, bruising, bleeding, new cough or breathlessness.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

The anatomical side-effect map follows.

REGIMEN-SPECIFIC SIDE EFFECTS

Your anatomical side-effect map

A picture of side effects

Match each symptom box to its numbered body location. Tell your team about new symptoms.

1 Brain / energy

Lomustine / tumour

Fatigue or headache may occur. New seizures, sudden weakness, speech difficulty or loss of consciousness needs emergency help.

3 Blood / infection

Lomustine

Low counts can be delayed for several weeks and build up over cycles. Fever, bruising or bleeding needs urgent advice.

5 Liver

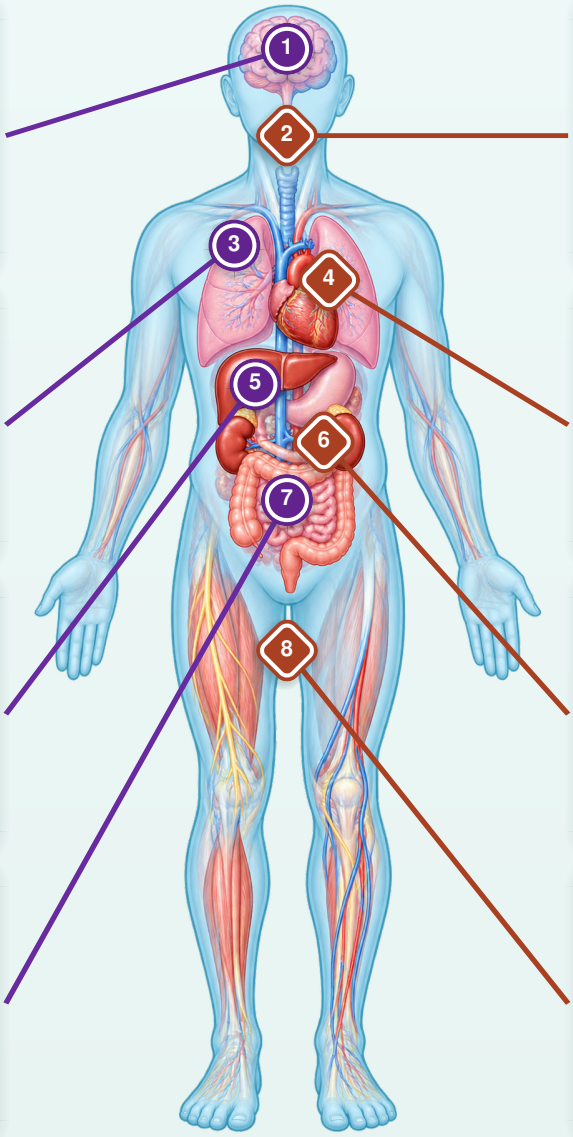
Lomustine

Attend liver tests and report yellow skin or eyes, dark urine or unusual itching. Do not assume a rest day means no risk.

7 Nausea / bowels

Lomustine / support medicines

Take anti-sickness medicine as prescribed. Call for repeated vomiting, inability to drink, constipation or abdominal pain.



2 Mouth / eating

Lomustine

Report mouth soreness or ulcers and reduced intake. Gentle mouth care and early help can support eating and drinking.

4 Lungs

Lomustine

Lung injury may develop during treatment. Report new cough or breathlessness and attend the lung checks arranged.

6 Kidneys / urine

Lomustine

Kidney checks guide safe treatment. Report reduced urine, swelling or difficulty drinking and follow the team's fluid advice.

8 Fertility / pregnancy

Lomustine

Discuss contraception and fertility before starting. Do not breastfeed during treatment. Follow written product-specific precautions.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

THE BIGGER TREATMENT PLAN

Your whole treatment course

42-DAY CYCLE

Lomustine for recurrent malignant glioma

Continue only after review **Lomustine once on D1, then no further doses in the 42-day cycle.**

Take lomustine once on Day 1 of a 42-day cycle. There are no further scheduled lomustine doses in that cycle. Treatment continues only while benefit and tolerance support it; no fixed total number of cycles is specified.

Each start, visit, delay or dose change is confirmed by your team. The card records treatment and does not authorise another dose.

Sources: nccp

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Tests, symptoms and treatment decisions

Medicine-safety checks, tumour-tissue testing and response imaging answer different questions. Product-information additions are labelled. No universal blood tumour-marker panel or scan interval is implied.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00805 v2 · current Irish regimen · NCCN Guidelines for Patients: Brain Cancer Glioma, 2026 · patient education reference · Lomustine medac current product information · January 2026

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Lomustine for recurrent malignant glioma: treatment and checks

NCCP 00805: recurrent malignant glioma.

Take lomustine once on Day 1 of a 42-day cycle. There are no further scheduled lomustine doses in that cycle. Treatment continues only while benefit and tolerance support it; no fixed total number of cycles is specified.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	During treatment	Between visits	Next treatment / response	After a pause or stop
Bloods / medicine safety NCCP 00805	Blood count, kidney and liver tests; NCCP lung testing for patients at high risk. Current lomustine SmPC additionally advises baseline lung-function assessment.	Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests. Current lomustine SmPC advises weekly blood counts for at least six weeks after each dose and continuing lung assessment; delayed and cumulative toxicity matters.	Keep additional tests even on days without an anticancer dose.	Team reviews current and previous results, symptoms and dose history.	Agree continuing checks; lomustine effects may persist.
Neurology / medicines / function NCCP 00805	Record usual symptoms, medicines, daily function and support needs.	Review headache, seizures, speech, strength, cognition and any steroid plan.	Report new changes early; do not wait for an MRI.	Discuss treatment tolerance, priorities and the next authorised dose.	Agree rehabilitation, symptom support and contacts.
Response / appointments NCCP 00805	Confirm exact diagnosis and baseline imaging.	Imaging and clinical review follow the specialist plan.	Record bookings, result-review contacts and questions.	Interpret scans with symptoms, treatment effects and medicines.	Agree the next imaging and clinical review.

What each check is for

1

Lomustine for recurrent malignant glioma

42-day cycle

Lomustine is an oral chemotherapy used to help control recurrent malignant glioma. The team considers your exact diagnosis, earlier treatments, function and priorities when deciding whether to continue.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, blood tests and support medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00805

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-05 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.39

Day 1 → Day 42: a general pattern

This is a visual orientation, not a prediction of your personal cycle. It shows when some effects often emerge and which effects are **not** tied to a particular day.

Take lomustine once on Day 1 of a 42-day cycle. There are no further scheduled lomustine doses in that cycle. Treatment continues only while benefit and tolerance support it; no fixed total number of cycles is specified.

Treatment timing: displayed days 1–42

Treatment or check	Days in this window	What happens
Lomustine · one oral dose	Day 1	Take once on Day 1 only; use the newly authorised prescription.
Continuing blood-count checks	Days 1–42	Lomustine SmPC advises weekly counts for at least six weeks; arrange all checks.
Symptoms and support between visits	Days 1–42	Keep the written emergency plan and do not wait for the next treatment to report changes.

A treatment record is not a prescription: The team may delay, alter or stop a component after reviewing symptoms, blood tests, organ function and previous toxicity. Do not restart a held medicine or add a replacement dose yourself.

Lomustine is one dose, not daily: Only the authorised Day 1 dose belongs to this cycle. Do not take a further course before six weeks and a new team decision. Taking repeated daily doses can cause serious harm. If a dose is missed or vomited, contact the team or pharmacist before taking any more. If an extra dose is taken, seek urgent clinical advice straight away even if you feel well; do not wait for symptoms.

Delayed marrow effects: Current lomustine product information advises blood counts weekly for at least six weeks after a dose. Low counts may be delayed and cumulative, so keep checks even when you feel well or the next treatment is postponed.

> **Why these bands stay broad:** Days without a scheduled dose still need symptom monitoring and planned tests. The calendar does not replace a treatment decision. Band length does not show likelihood or severity, and the chart cannot tell you whether it is safe to receive treatment. NCCP 00805 v2 · current Irish regimen ↗

> **There are no guaranteed "safe days".** Use your oncology unit's written emergency plan. Fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell needs urgent advice even on days without chemotherapy. Call 112 or 999 for a new seizure, sudden weakness or speech difficulty, loss of consciousness, severe breathing difficulty or uncontrolled bleeding. If you have an established seizure rescue plan, follow it and its emergency instructions.

Complete timing and symptom notes

Day 1: One authorised capsule dose

Check the correct total dose and capsule strengths with the pharmacist. Take the prescribed anti-sickness plan. Lomustine is not taken daily.

Day 2–42: No scheduled lomustine; continue monitoring

Blood counts may fall weeks after the dose. Attend weekly blood-count checks and other planned reviews. Do not take another dose until the team has reviewed you and issued instructions.

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking the treatment

Take lomustine only once on the authorised Day 1. The pharmacist must confirm the total dose, capsule strengths, how to take it and anti-sickness timing. Do not open or crush capsules or take another dose to replace a missed or vomited one without advice.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held medicine

If a capsule dose is missed or vomited, call the oncology team or pharmacist before taking more. Do not double up or use leftover capsules. An infusion or capsule held for toxicity needs a new team decision.

STEP 3

Medicine and supplement review

Bring all prescription, over-the-counter and herbal medicines, vitamins and supplements to review. Include steroids, seizure medicines, anticoagulants and any recent antibiotics or antifungals. Tell the team before starting or stopping a medicine.

STEP 4

Capsule supply and handling

Lomustine is supplied as an unlicensed medicine in this NCCP protocol. Confirm pharmacy supply in advance. Keep the labelled pack away from children and do not open or crush capsules. Return unused chemotherapy to the pharmacy; contact staff if swallowing or handling is difficult.

STEP 5

Pregnancy, breastfeeding and fertility

Discuss fertility preservation and contraception before starting. Treatment can harm a pregnancy. Do not breastfeed during treatment. Ask for the written medicine-specific precautions and the required periods after stopping; these may differ between products.

STEP 6

Appointments and transport

Before starting: Blood count, kidney and liver tests; NCCP lung testing for patients at high risk. Current lomustine SmPC additionally advises baseline lung-function assessment. During treatment: Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests. Current lomustine SmPC advises weekly blood counts for at least six weeks after each dose and continuing lung assessment; delayed and cumulative toxicity matters. MRI and neurological review follow your individual treatment plan.

STEP 7

Help with the daily plan

Agree who can help with transport, prescriptions, phone calls and recording symptoms if memory, vision, weakness or fatigue makes them difficult. Your consent and preferences guide what is shared. Keep the printed schedule and actual urgent contacts together.

Sources: NCCP 00805 v2 · current Irish regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.

MAKE THE PLAN PRACTICAL

Support around the medicines

1 Lomustine nausea prevention

Lomustine has moderate-to-high oral emetic potential. Take the prescribed prevention and rescue plan around the single dose. Contact the team if nausea or vomiting prevents fluids or essential medicines; do not automatically repeat a vomited chemotherapy dose.

2 Separate steroid, seizure and bowel plans

Keep steroids and seizure medicines on their own written schedules if prescribed. Ask what to do after a missed or vomited dose. Other medicines can worsen constipation; agree a bowel plan and have all new medicines checked for interactions.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 01

Your treatment and its purpose

Keep the exact diagnosis, regimen and treatment goal together.

Why this treatment?

Lomustine is an oral chemotherapy used to help control recurrent malignant glioma. The team considers your exact diagnosis, earlier treatments, function and priorities when deciding whether to continue.

Sources: nccp

What each medicine does

Lomustine: Lomustine is an oral nitrosourea chemotherapy that can reach the brain. It damages DNA and interferes with cell division. Its effects on healthy blood-forming cells can appear several weeks after the dose and can build up over successive cycles. This explains the long gap between doses and the need for continuing blood tests.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Your schedule

Take lomustine once on Day 1 of a 42-day cycle. There are no further scheduled lomustine doses in that cycle. Treatment continues only while benefit and tolerance support it; no fixed total number of cycles is specified.

Sources: nccp

Evidence and uncertainty

Discuss expected disease control, symptoms, burdens and alternatives with the team. A result from one dose or population is not an individual forecast. The EORTC 26101 monotherapy arm used 110 mg/m², maximum 200 mg, rather than the NCCP 00805 starting schedule of 130 mg/m², maximum 280 mg. A study comparing two active regimens does not establish the benefit of this schedule over no treatment. Previous therapy, integrated diagnosis, function and toxicity affect applicability.

Sources: nccp · eortc26101 · eortc-methods

Consent and decisions

Discuss the exact diagnosis, treatment goal, evidence limits, alternatives and burdens; medicine-specific risks, monitoring, fertility and pregnancy precautions; any unlicensed supply or off-label use; and practical support. Keep steroid and seizure plans separate from anticancer treatment.

Sources: nccp

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 02

Taking treatment and organising visits

Different medicines and support plans have different days.

Taking the treatment

Take lomustine only once on the authorised Day 1. The pharmacist must confirm the total dose, capsule strengths, how to take it and anti-sickness timing. Do not open or crush capsules or take another dose to replace a missed or vomited one without advice.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Missed, vomited or held medicine

If a capsule dose is missed or vomited, call the oncology team or pharmacist before taking more. Do not double up or use leftover capsules. An infusion or capsule held for toxicity needs a new team decision.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Medicine and supplement review

Bring all prescription, over-the-counter and herbal medicines, vitamins and supplements to review. Include steroids, seizure medicines, anticoagulants and any recent antibiotics or antifungals. Tell the team before starting or stopping a medicine.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Capsule supply and handling

Lomustine is supplied as an unlicensed medicine in this NCCP protocol. Confirm pharmacy supply in advance. Keep the labelled pack away from children and do not open or crush capsules. Return unused chemotherapy to the pharmacy; contact staff if swallowing or handling is difficult.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

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Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

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Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Help with the daily plan

Agree who can help with transport, prescriptions, phone calls and recording symptoms if memory, vision, weakness or fatigue makes them difficult. Your consent and preferences guide what is shared. Keep the printed schedule and actual urgent contacts together.

Sources: nccn-patient

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 03

Safety tests, support and urgent symptoms

A treatment-free day is still part of the care plan.

Which tests and when?

Before starting: Blood count, kidney and liver tests; NCCP lung testing for patients at high risk. Current lomustine SmPC additionally advises baseline lung-function assessment. During treatment: Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests. Current lomustine SmPC advises weekly blood counts for at least six weeks after each dose and continuing lung assessment; delayed and cumulative toxicity matters. MRI and neurological review follow your individual treatment plan.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Lomustine nausea prevention

Lomustine has moderate-to-high oral emetic potential. Take the prescribed prevention and rescue plan around the single dose. Contact the team if nausea or vomiting prevents fluids or essential medicines; do not automatically repeat a vomited chemotherapy dose.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc

Separate steroid, seizure and bowel plans

Keep steroids and seizure medicines on their own written schedules if prescribed. Ask what to do after a missed or vomited dose. Other medicines can worsen constipation; agree a bowel plan and have all new medicines checked for interactions.

Sources: nccp · nhs-dexamethasone · nccn-patient

When to call

Use your oncology unit's written emergency plan. Fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell needs urgent advice even on days without chemotherapy. Call 112 or 999 for a new seizure, sudden weakness or speech difficulty, loss of consciousness, severe breathing difficulty or uncontrolled bleeding. If you have an established seizure rescue plan, follow it and its emergency instructions. Call promptly for fever, bleeding, new cough or breathlessness, persistent vomiting or reduced urine. Do not take another lomustine dose without a new instruction.

Sources: nccp · lomustine-smpc · nci-cns

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 04

Understanding your particular glioma

Your diagnosis includes the tumour's cells, molecular findings and behaviour, not just the word brain cancer.

The name and location

Gliomas begin in supporting cells of the brain or spinal cord. Astrocytoma, oligodendroglioma and glioblastoma are different diagnoses. A tumour that spread to the brain from another organ is a brain metastasis and is not covered by these glioma regimens. Record the exact integrated diagnosis and where it is located.

Sources: nccn-patient

Grade is not the same as stage

Grade describes features linked to how a tumour behaves. Adult gliomas are usually discussed by their type, grade and molecular findings rather than the stage system used for many other cancers. Grade 4 does not mean cancer has spread through the body. Ask your specialist to explain your own report and any older terminology in the treatment protocol.

Sources: nccn-patient · nci-cns

IDH and 1p/19q

IDH1 or IDH2 changes and loss of parts of chromosomes 1p and 19q help classify particular gliomas. The combination of findings matters: one result should not be read in isolation. These tests are usually performed on tumour tissue. They do not automatically mean a change has been inherited or that relatives need testing.

Sources: nccn-patient

MGMT promoter methylation

MGMT is involved in repairing certain DNA damage. Methylation of its promoter can reduce that repair activity and helps the team discuss the likely benefit of temozolomide in relevant settings. It is not a blood tumour marker, a percentage of tumour left, or an individual survival prediction. Record the reported result and ask how it affects your treatment choice.

Sources: nccn-patient

A useful diagnosis record

Keep the biopsy or operation date, pathology wording, grade, IDH result, 1p/19q result and MGMT result if tested. Mark a result as pending or not applicable rather than assuming it is negative. Ask whether specialist pathology review or further testing would change the plan.

Sources: nccn-patient

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 05

Tests and scans: what each one tells you

Safety blood tests, tumour tissue tests and MRI answer different questions.

Safety blood tests

A full blood count checks infection-fighting white cells, oxygen-carrying red cells and platelets that help stop bleeding. Kidney and liver tests help assess treatment safety. Attend the regimen’s required tests even when you feel well; a reassuring scan does not replace them. The schedule in this guide separates checks before, during and after treatment.

Sources: nccp · nccn-patient

MRI and neurological review

MRI is the main scan used to assess many gliomas. Your team also considers symptoms, strength, movement, speech, memory, daily function and medicines such as steroids. Tell staff before MRI about implants or metal, kidney problems, previous contrast reactions or difficulty lying still. Ask about support if scans make you anxious.

Sources: nccn-patient

Changes on a scan need interpretation

After treatment, inflammation and other treatment effects can resemble tumour growth on MRI. This is sometimes called pseudoprogression. The team may need comparison scans, specialist imaging or further assessment before deciding what a change means. New or worsening symptoms still need prompt review; do not assume they are harmless treatment effects.

Sources: nccn-patient

An individual follow-up timetable

Write the next MRI date, what question it should answer and who will explain the result. Timing depends on your diagnosis, treatment phase and previous findings. General follow-up intervals in an international booklet are not automatically your schedule. These regimens do not require a generic CT chest/abdomen/pelvis or a blood tumour marker before every cycle.

Sources: nccn-patient

Keep results with decisions

Use the passport to distinguish a test being booked, completed and reviewed. Record the agreed next step and whom to call if an appointment or result is missing. Do not alter chemotherapy or steroids yourself in response to a number or scan report.

Sources: nccn-patient

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 06

Brain symptoms, medicines and when to call

Symptoms may reflect the tumour, swelling, treatment, another medicine or a separate illness.

Know your usual symptoms

Write down your usual headache, strength, walking, speech, vision, memory, mood, sleep and seizure pattern before treatment. Note new changes, when they started and how they affect daily tasks. With your permission, a trusted person can help spot changes or record what happened.

Sources: nccn-patient

Urgent neurological changes

Use your oncology unit’s written emergency plan. Fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell needs urgent advice even on days without chemotherapy. Call 112 or 999 for a new seizure, sudden weakness or speech difficulty, loss of consciousness, severe breathing difficulty or uncontrolled bleeding. If you have an established seizure rescue plan, follow it and its emergency instructions.

Sources: nccp · nccn-patient

Steroids need a separate written plan

Steroids may be prescribed to reduce swelling around the tumour. They are not automatically needed for everyone. Ask for the exact dose, time, review date and any taper plan. Do not stop or change them suddenly without advice. Report sleep or mood changes, increased thirst, infection symptoms or muscle weakness and ask which additional checks or protection you need.

Sources: nccn-patient · nhs-dexamethasone

Seizure medicines and rescue instructions

If prescribed, take seizure medicines on the agreed schedule. Ask what to do after a missed or vomited dose and whom to contact for breakthrough symptoms. Some medicines can affect mood, alertness or interact with treatment. Do not start, stop or switch them yourself. A rescue medicine needs an individual plan and training for whoever may give it.

Sources: nccn-patient

Safety at home and outside

Ask your clinical team about driving, work, bathing, swimming, heights and machinery in light of your symptoms and any seizures. Local medical and licensing rules need individual advice; this guide does not give a universal driving clearance date. Occupational therapy can help adapt daily routines and the home.

Sources: nccn-patient

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 07

Your overall treatment plan and choices

Treatment should account for the tumour and the life you want to lead.

Understand the sequence

Surgery or biopsy, radiotherapy, chemotherapy and follow-up have different jobs. Ask your team to draw the intended sequence and identify where you are now. Concurrent treatment means treatments overlap; adjuvant treatment follows the main treatment. A change of phase may change the dose, blood tests and support medicines.

Sources: nccn-patient

Agree what treatment is trying to achieve

Ask whether the aim is to control the tumour, delay growth, relieve symptoms, preserve function or a combination of these. Discuss likely benefits, burdens, alternatives and what would prompt a pause or stop. The answer depends on the exact diagnosis, previous treatment and your priorities.

Sources: nccn-patient

Put evidence in context

Clinical trials describe groups of people and may use older pathology names or different schedules. They cannot predict one person’s response or lifespan. Ask how closely the evidence matches your tumour and treatment. No benefit number from one schedule should automatically be applied to another.

Sources: nccn-patient

Discuss options available to you

Ask about appropriate clinical trials, specialist opinions, symptom support and other treatment options. A medicine or device described in an international guide is not automatically licensed, funded or suitable in Ireland. The treating multidisciplinary team explains what is available and relevant.

Sources: nccn-patient

Make room for your priorities

Bring up fatigue, thinking, independence, family time, work, travel and side effects you most want to avoid. Ask for information at a pace and in a format that suits you. You may ask for a trusted person to join the discussion, written notes and time to reconsider decisions.

Sources: nccn-patient

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 08

Living well, rehabilitation and support

Practical and symptom support can begin alongside anticancer treatment.

Thinking, communication and daily tasks

Tell the team about word-finding, attention, memory, reading, vision or planning difficulties. Rehabilitation may include physiotherapy, occupational therapy, speech and language therapy, or neuropsychological support. Written routines, rest breaks and help with medicine organisation can make day-to-day care more manageable.

Sources: nccn-patient

Food, nausea, bowels and energy

Report poor appetite, weight change, vomiting or constipation early. Ask for dietitian help if eating is difficult. Use the prescribed anti-sickness and bowel plan; do not wait until symptoms are severe. Choose activity that is safe for your balance and strength and balance it with rest. Ask about treatable causes of fatigue.

Sources: nccp · nccn-patient

Emotional support and carers

Anxiety, low mood, changes in behaviour and uncertainty can affect both patients and carers. Tell the team what has changed and ask for appropriate psychological or social support. Carers may need their own information, practical help and breaks. Agree who the team may share information with.

Sources: nccn-patient

Work, transport and finances

Ask the specialist nurse or social worker about getting to treatment, time off work, benefits, caring responsibilities and support at home. Plan who can help with medicines, symptom recording and appointments if your memory, vision or fatigue makes these difficult.

Sources: nccn-patient

Supportive care and future wishes

Supportive and palliative care can help with symptoms and quality of life while active treatment continues. You can discuss future care preferences and who you want involved in decisions at a time that suits you. Ask the team for Irish advice and documentation rather than using legal or hospice rules from a US booklet.

Sources: nccn-patient

Information that works on paper

Keep the printed schedule, current medicine list, tests, contact numbers and emergency instructions together. This handbook can be read in sequence without internet access. The wallet card and optional QR code help others find the regimen information; they do not replace your prescription or emergency plan.

Sources: nccn-patient

Lomustine evidence: exact regimen matters

Lomustine is used as a comparator and treatment option in recurrent glioma studies.

Discuss expected disease control, symptoms, burdens and alternatives with the team. A result from one dose or population is not an individual forecast.

Sources: nccp · eortc26101 · eortc-methods

PREPARE FOR THE CONVERSATION

Questions worth asking

What is my exact diagnosis and how does this regimen fit?

NCCP 00805: recurrent malignant glioma. Ask for the pathology, relevant molecular findings and the treatment goal in plain language.

Which medicines do I receive on which days?

Take lomustine once on Day 1 of a 42-day cycle. There are no further scheduled lomustine doses in that cycle. Treatment continues only while benefit and tolerance support it; no fixed total number of cycles is specified.

Which tests must happen before the next treatment?

Before starting: Blood count, kidney and liver tests; NCCP lung testing for patients at high risk. Current lomustine SmPC additionally advises baseline lung-function assessment. During treatment: Regular blood count, kidney and liver tests. Current lomustine SmPC advises weekly blood counts for at least six weeks after each dose and continuing lung assessment; delayed and cumulative toxicity matters. MRI and neurological review follow your individual treatment plan.

How do I handle a missed, vomited or held dose?

Contact the oncology team or pharmacist for medicine-specific instructions. Do not double a dose or replace treatment that was held for toxicity.

Who helps with steroids, seizures, hearing, memory or daily tasks?

Ask for written medicine plans and a named contact. Rehabilitation, practical support and a trusted helper may support the daily plan.

Which symptoms mean I should call now?

Use your oncology unit's written emergency plan. Fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell needs urgent advice even on days without chemotherapy. Call 112 or 999 for a new seizure, sudden weakness or speech difficulty, loss of consciousness, severe breathing difficulty or uncontrolled bleeding. If you have an established seizure rescue plan, follow it and its emergency instructions. Call promptly for fever, bleeding, new cough or breathlessness, persistent vomiting or reduced urine. Do not take another lomustine dose without a new instruction.

When do we review whether treatment is helping?

Agree the next clinical and imaging review, what would count as benefit, how side effects will be weighed and what would lead to continuing, changing or stopping.

> **Try explaining the plan back:** Can you show the day for each medicine, your next safety tests, the current support plan and whom to call for fever, new neurological symptoms or another urgent change?

SOURCE TRANSPARENCY

Where this information comes from

Regimen schedule: NCCP 00805 v2. Medicine explanations and safety information: sources below. The timeline is an educational illustration, not a measured risk curve or an individual prediction.

- NCCP 00805 v2 · current Irish regimen
- NCCN Guidelines for Patients: Brain Cancer Glioma, 2026 · patient education reference
- NCI: adult central nervous system tumours · diagnosis and grade education
- NHS: dexamethasone · use and stopping safely
- Lomustine medac current product information · January 2026
- Wick 2017: lomustine and bevacizumab in progressive glioblastoma
- EORTC 26101 original methods · trial doses and schedules

SACTCheck · Developed by Dr Paul O'Brien · Sources checked 2026-11-05.

This information supports your treatment discussion. Your oncology team confirms your personal treatment and urgent-care plan.

Written source addresses

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6871/805_V2_Lomustine_130mg_Therapy.pdf

https://www.nccn.org/patients/guidelines/content/PDF/brain-gliomas-patient.pdf

https://www.medac.eu/fileadmin/user_upload/medac-eu/SPCs/common_SPCs/Lomustine_medac-spc-common.pdf

https://www.cancer.gov/types/brain/patient/adult-brain-treatment-pdq

https://www.nhs.uk/medicines/dexamethasone-tablets-and-liquid/how-and-when-to-take-dexamethasone-tablets-and-liquid/

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29141164/

https://www.nejm.org/doi/full/10.1056/NEJMoa1707358